The Window

Anas

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The Letter

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He made coffee the way his grandfather had taught him, slowly, with more patience than the drink deserved. The letter sat on the table where he had left it, folded once, creased twice, read four times.

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The walk to the post office took him past the bookshop with the blue door. He had spent whole summers in its back room, trading chores for secondhand novels and advice he did not know he needed.

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A cat followed him for half a block, then lost interest at the fishmonger's corner. He chose to take it as a sign, though of what he could not have said.

The afternoon stretched long and golden. Somewhere a radio played an old song, and the whole neighborhood seemed to hum along without quite knowing the words.

He bought bread, oranges, and a small bunch of mint, because some habits are worth keeping no matter what the postman brings or takes away.

At the cafe, Si Driss slid a glass of tea across the counter before he even sat down. **'You look like a man who made a decision,'** he said. 'Those are the dangerous ones.'

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The Blue Door

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What Madame Rkia Knew

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Starting Over

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The Long Way Home

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The Answer

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The Harbor

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What the Sea Kept

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The Second Letter

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The Wedding Plan

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Home Again

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The Crossing

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The Old Lighthouse

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By noon the reply was written, sealed, and sent. He stood on the steps of the post office feeling lighter than he had in months, as if the city itself had agreed to start over.

Night came gently. He read the letter one more time, then put it in the drawer where he kept the things that mattered, and slept better than he had in weeks.